Lesson 2 — The Lost Photographs

Level: A1+ → A2 (second step)

Theme: Keeping files safe, student life

Time: 6 sessions, 45–55 minutes each

Skills: Listening → Reading → Vocabulary → Grammar → Comprehension → Speaking → Writing

New in this lesson: the past simple (studied, took, lost), a longer passage of 244 words, sentence insertion, a two-sentence written summary, and the first spaced recall of Lesson 1 vocabulary

01 · Passage — The Lost Photographs

> How to do the listening. Same rule as Lesson 1: the student listens twice with no text, then reads. Audio files: `01-passage.mp3` first, then the other parts in order. Part `05-ed-sounds.mp3` is new — a past-simple verb drill.

1.1 Before listening (2 minutes, Arabic is fine here)

1. What is on your phone that you would not want to lose?
2. Have you ever lost a phone, a file, or a photograph?
3. Where do you keep a second copy of important things?

1.4 Now read the passage

Passage: The Lost Photographs (244 words)

Last year, Maha was a student at a college in Gaza. She studied design, and she loved her work. Every week she took photographs of her city — the market, the sea, the old streets. She kept all of them on her phone.

[A] One morning in May, Maha put her phone in her bag and went to college. At eleven o'clock, she opened the bag. The phone was not there. She looked everywhere, but she did not find it.

[B] She was sad about the phone, but she was much sadder about the photographs. There were more than two thousand of them, and she had no other copy. Three years of work disappeared in one morning.

[C] Her teacher listened to her story and asked one question: "Did you have a backup?" Maha did not know the word. The teacher explained it in a simple way. A backup is a second copy of your files in another place. If you lose the first copy, you still have the second one.

[D] That week, Maha learned how to make backups. She copied her new photographs to a laptop. She also copied the most important ones to a memory card, and she kept the card at home. When the internet was good, she sent some folders to an online drive.

Maha still remembers her lost photographs. But now she says the same thing to every new student: "Your phone is not a safe place. It is only one place."

1.5 Read aloud

Read the passage aloud once and record it. Compare it with your Lesson 1 recording: are the sentences easier now?

02 · Listening questions

1.2 Listening — first time (no text)

L1. Who is the story about?

L2. What did she lose?

L3. Did the story happen this year or last year?

L4. Who asked her a question about a backup?

1.3 Listening — second time (no text)

Write four verbs you heard. Then write one word you heard but did not understand.

03 · Vocabulary and Lesson 1 recall

2.1 Key words

#	WORD	TYPE	SIMPLE MEANING	ARABIC	EXAMPLE
1	college	noun	a place to study after school	كلية	She was a student at a college.
2	design	noun	planning how something looks	تصميم	She studied design.
3	keep / kept	verb	to have something and not lose it	يحفظ	She kept the photos on her phone.
4	lose / lost	verb	to not have something any more	يفقد	She lost her phone.
5	everywhere	adverb	in every place	في كل مكان	She looked everywhere.
6	disappear	verb	to go away and not be seen	يختفي	Three years of work disappeared.
7	copy	noun / verb	another one exactly the same	نسخة / ينسخ	She had no other copy.
8	backup	noun	a second copy kept in another place	نسخة احتياطية	Did you have a backup?
9	explain	verb	to make something easy to understand	يشرح	The teacher explained it.
10	memory card	noun	a small card that holds files	بطاقة ذاكرة	She used a memory card.
11	folder	noun	a place on a computer that holds files	مجلد	She sent some folders.
12	drive	noun	a place that stores files (here: online)	مشغّل / سحابة	She used an online drive.
13	important	adjective	something that matters a lot	مهم	The most important photos.
14	remember	verb	to keep something in your mind	يتذكر	She still remembers them.

2.2 Synonyms and opposites

WORD	SYNONYM	OPPOSITE
lose	misplace	find / keep
disappear	go away	appear
important	serious, big	small, not important
remember	keep in mind	forget

WORD	SYNONYM	OPPOSITE
sad	unhappy	happy / glad
explain	make clear	confuse
safe	protected	in danger
everywhere	in all places	nowhere

2.3 Expressions to learn

EXPRESSION	WHAT IT REALLY MEANS
make a backup	create a second copy of your files
look everywhere	search in all places
in one morning	in a very short time
the most important	more important than all the others
three years of work	work that took three years
she had no other copy	there was only one copy, and it was lost
it is only one place	do not trust one place alone

2.4 Vocabulary practice

A. Write the opposite:

1. remember → _____
2. find → _____
3. appear → _____
4. happy → _____
5. nowhere → _____

B. Which word is different? Say why:

1. folder — copy — backup — market
2. college — teacher — student — memory card
3. lost — kept — took — important

C. Say it in your own words:

1. What is a backup?
2. What does everywhere mean?

04 · Grammar — the past simple

Come back to: the present simple

You met this in Lesson 1. Two lines to remind you:

I / YOU / WE / THEY	WORK
he / she / it	works

New this time: where the frequency word goes.

always, usually, often, sometimes, never come before the verb:

> She often takes photographs.
> He never uses a computer.

But they come after am, is and are:

> The internet is often slow.
> She is never late.

Quick practice. Put the word in the right place and write the sentence:

1. (always) She saves her work. → _____
2. (never) He is late. → _____
3. (sometimes) The electricity stops. → _____

We use the past simple for a finished action in the past: Last year she studied design.

3.1 Regular verbs — add -ed

NOW	LAST YEAR
study	studied
love	loved
look	looked
copy	copied
explain	explained
disappear	disappeared
learn	learned
remember	remembered

3.2 Irregular verbs — you must learn each one

NOW	LAST YEAR
is / are	was / were
take	took
keep	kept
put	put
go	went
open	opened (regular)
find	found
have	had
say	said
send	sent

3.4 Negative and question

	FORM	EXAMPLE
Negative	did not + base verb	She did not find it. (not did not found)
Question	Did + person + base verb	Did you have a backup?

3.5 Grammar practice

A. Put the verb in the past simple:

1. Last year she _____ (study) design.
2. She _____ (take) photographs every week.
3. She _____ (put) her phone in her bag.
4. She _____ (not find) it.
5. The teacher _____ (explain) the word.
6. She _____ (send) some folders to an online drive.

B. Write the question:

1. _____ you _____ (have) a backup?
2. _____ she _____ (find) her phone?

05 · The three sounds of -ed

3.3 The three sounds of -ed (listen to `05-ed-sounds.mp3`)

In the audio these are called sound one, sound two and sound three, in the same order as the table.

SOUND	EXAMPLE	WHY
/t/	looked, helped	after a quiet sound like k, p, s
/d/	loved, explained	after a voiced sound like v, n, l
/ɪd/	wanted, needed	after t or d

06 · Comprehension — TOEFL question types

Part A — Multiple choice

1. (Factual) What did Maha study at college?

   A. Photography
   B. Design
   C. Computers
   D. The passage does not say

2. (Factual) When did Maha lose her phone?

   A. On a morning in May
   B. At eleven o'clock at night
   C. Three years ago
   D. On her way home from the market

3. (Negative factual) According to the passage, Maha made a copy of her photographs in all of the following places EXCEPT

   A. a laptop
   B. a memory card
   C. an online drive
   D. a second phone

4. (Vocabulary in context) The word "disappeared" in the passage is closest in meaning to

   A. became old
   B. were sold
   C. were gone
   D. became slow

5. (Reference) In the sentence "If you lose the first copy, you still have the second one", the word "one" refers to

   A. the file
   B. the copy
   C. the place
   D. the phone

6. (Inference) It can be inferred from the passage that Maha

   A. did not understand the word backup before she lost her phone
   B. found her phone later that week
   C. stopped taking photographs after that day
   D. did not trust her teacher

7. (Sentence insertion — NEW) Look at the four letters [A] [B] [C] [D] in the passage. Where would this sentence best fit?

> She asked her friends, she asked the college office, and she walked back to the market.

- A. At [A]
- B. At [B]
- C. At [C]
- D. At [D]

Part C — Fill in the blanks

Use these words. There are two extra words you will not need.

> backup · college · everywhere · disappeared · copy · folders · memory card · important · explained · design

1. Maha was a student at a _____ in Gaza.
2. She looked _____, but she did not find the phone.
3. Three years of work _____ in one morning.
4. A _____ is a second copy of your files in another place.
5. The teacher _____ the word in a simple way.
6. She copied the most _____ photographs to a _____.
7. She sent some _____ to an online drive.

Part D — Summary (NEW)

Write the story in two sentences only. Use the past simple.

> Sentence 1 — what happened: _____ Sentence 2 — what she learned: _____

07 · True / false

Part B — True / False

Write T or F. If it is false, write the correct sentence.

1. Maha was a teacher at the college. ____
2. She had more than two thousand photographs. ____
3. She had a second copy of her photographs on a laptop before she lost the phone. ____
4. Her teacher asked her about a backup. ____
5. She kept the memory card at the college. ____
6. She sent some folders to an online drive when the internet was good. ____

08 · Speaking

5.1 Speaking (record each answer, 45 seconds)

1. Tell the story of Maha in your own words. Use last year, then, after that.
2. Tell me about a time you lost something. What happened?
3. Where do you keep your important files? Is that safe? Why?

Useful sentence starters:

Last year, I ____.

One day, I lost ____.

I looked everywhere, but I did not find it.

After that, I learned to ____.

I keep my files on ____, because ____.

09 · Writing — The Day I Lost Something

5.2 Writing — "The Day I Lost Something" (8–10 sentences)

Model answer (copy the shape, change the words):

> Last year, I lost my student card. One morning, I put it in my pocket and went to college. At ten o'clock, I opened my pocket, but the card was not there. I looked everywhere. I asked my friends, and I walked back to the bus station. I did not find it. The office gave me a new card after one week. Now I keep a photograph of my card on my computer. It is a small backup, but it helps.

Checklist before you send it:

- [ ] I used the past simple in every sentence about the past.
- [ ] I wrote did not find, not did not found.
- [ ] I used at least 5 new words from Session 2.
- [ ] I used at least 2 irregular verbs from Session 3.2.
- [ ] Capital letters and full stops are correct.
- [ ] My text has 8–10 sentences.

10 · Review

6.1 Listen again (no text)

1. Name three places where Maha put a copy of her photographs.
2. What does she say now to every new student?

6.2 Mini-quiz (12 marks)

1. The past simple of take is _____.
2. The past simple of keep is _____.
3. The past simple of study is _____.
4. The opposite of remember is _____.
5. The opposite of appear is _____.
6. A second copy of your files in another place = a _____.
7. A place on a computer that holds files = a _____.
8. In every place = _____.
9. Write a question in the past simple using did.
10. Write a negative sentence in the past simple.
11. Write one sentence with important.
12. Tell the story of the passage in one sentence, from memory.

6.3 Lesson 2 self-report

QUESTION	ANSWER
Minutes studied this week	
Hardest part (listening / reading / vocabulary / grammar / speaking / writing)	
Past-simple verbs I can now use without thinking	
Words from Lesson 1 I have forgotten	
One thing I want to repeat next week	

11 · Answer key and teacher notes

Listening: L1 — Maha, a student (at a college in Gaza) · L2 — her phone, and more than two thousand photographs · L3 — last year · L4 — her teacher

Part A (MCQ): 1-B · 2-A · 3-D · 4-C · 5-B · 6-A · 7-B

Why 7 is [B]: the sentence describes searching, so it follows "She looked everywhere, but she did not find it." — it belongs at the start of the next paragraph, before she turns to the photographs.

Part B (True/False):

1. F — She was a student at the college.
2. T
3. F — She had no other copy before she lost the phone.
4. T
5. F — She kept the memory card at home.
6. T

Part C (Fill in the blanks): 1. college · 2. everywhere · 3. disappeared · 4. backup · 5. explained · 6. important, memory card · 7. folders (Extra words: copy, design)

2.4 A (Opposites): 1. forget · 2. lose · 3. disappear · 4. sad / unhappy · 5. everywhere

2.4 B (Odd one out): 1. market (the others are computer words) · 2. memory card (the others are people/ places at a college) · 3. important (the others are past-simple verbs)

3.5 A (Past simple): 1. studied · 2. took · 3. put · 4. did not find · 5. explained · 6. sent 3.5 B (Questions): 1. Did … have · 2. Did … find

Come back to (frequency words): 1. She always saves her work. · 2. He is never late. · 3. Sometimes the electricity stops. / The electricity sometimes stops.

Mini-quiz: 1. took · 2. kept · 3. studied · 4. forget · 5. disappear · 6. backup · 7. folder · 8. everywhere · 9–12. teacher judgement

Teacher Notes

What changed from Lesson 1. The passage grew from 185 to 244 words, the tense moved from present simple to past simple, and a seventh question type (sentence insertion) joined the set. Everything else — the order of the sessions, the five original TOEFL question types, the self-report — is deliberately identical, so only one thing is new at a time.

The one real difficulty. Not the vocabulary: the did not + base verb rule. Arabic speakers very often produce did not found, because the past is already marked once. Correct it every time this week, even in speech, and it usually settles by Lesson 4.

Why this story. The student is a postgraduate applying for an exchange: within a year they will be carrying their own application files, scans and transcripts between machines. The passage teaches the vocabulary of that problem while teaching the tense.

Success criteria for Lesson 2. The student should be able to:

- answer L1–L4 correctly on the second hearing;
- retell the story in 4–5 past-simple sentences without the text;
- form a correct negative and a correct question in the past simple;
- use 10 of the 14 key words in their own sentence;
- write 8 sentences about a personal past event with fewer than 4 tense errors.

If it is too easy: Lesson 3 goes to 320 words with past continuous (while she was walking), and the MCQ set adds a "purpose of the paragraph" question. If it is too hard: keep the same passage for a second week, drop the sentence-insertion question, and drill only Session 3.1 and 3.4.

A note on Lesson 1 words. The self-report asks which Lesson 1 words have been forgotten on purpose, and `05-ed-sounds.mp3`'s companion — the last minute of `03-vocabulary.mp3` — brings five Lesson 1 words back with a five-second gap before the meaning is given. Keep that habit every week: spaced recall, not repetition inside one week, is what moves vocabulary into long-term memory.